

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/9: Responsible executive: Articles 74, 75, 77 and 78

FORMAL HEAD

REAL EXECUTIVE

President

Prime Minister + Council of Ministers

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+-- ARTICLE 74: aid and advice --+

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ARTICLE 75 -> appointment, tenure, responsibility, six-month rule, ministry cap

ARTICLE 77 -> Union business in President's name + Rules of Business

ARTICLE 78 -> PM informs President and submits matters for reconsideration

CORE RESULT

executive power is politically answerable to Lok Sabha through responsible government.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/9: Prime Minister appointment and government formation

CLEAR MAJORITY

President appoints recognised majority leader -> ministers on PM advice

HUNG LOK SABHA

objective support evidence -> appoint person most likely to command confidence

-> prompt floor test -> ministry survives or resigns

ELIGIBILITY

minister may be non-member for six consecutive months

disqualified person cannot use six-month rule to evade the Constitution

TENURE

no fixed PM term; office depends on Lok Sabha confidence and constitutional continuity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/9: Council, Cabinet, ranks and the 91st Amendment

COUNCIL OF MINISTERS

larger constitutional body

Cabinet + Ministers of State + deputies

Article 74

CABINET

inner decision-making core

senior portfolios and collective direction

Article 352 expressly names Cabinet

RANKS

Cabinet Minister | Minister of State (independent charge / attached) | Deputy Minister

labels such as parliamentary secretary do not automatically create Cabinet rank

91ST AMENDMENT

Union ministry $\leq$ 15% of Lok Sabha strength

Tenth Schedule defector disqualified from ministerial appointment for the stated period.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/9: Collective, individual and legal responsibility

COLLECTIVE: ARTICLE 75(3)

one political unit -> Cabinet solidarity -> Lok Sabha confidence

loss of confidence -> whole ministry resigns

INDIVIDUAL: ARTICLE 75(2)

minister holds office during President's pleasure, exercised within PM-led government

PM may require resignation or advise dismissal

LEGAL RESPONSIBILITY

India lacks the British rule requiring a ministerial countersignature on every formal act

Article 77 authentication protects authorised orders from challenge on signature form alone

ACCOUNTABILITY CHAIN

decision -> shared defence -> questions/committee/audit -> confidence sanction.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/9: Prime Minister's five relationship arenas

COUNCIL / CABINET

selects team, allocates portfolios, sets agenda, coordinates and can seek resignation

PRESIDENT

principal adviser + Article 78 information bridge + reconsideration channel

PARLIAMENT

government leader, confidence manager, policy statement and legislative programme

PARTY / COALITION

leadership depends on majority, alliance agreements, internal bargaining and legitimacy

FEDERAL / NATIONAL

intergovernmental leadership, crisis coordination and national policy direction.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/9: Cabinet ecosystem: committees, Secretariat and PMO

ARTICLE 72(3) RULES

Allocation of Business -> who handles a subject

Transaction of Business -> how important business moves and is decided

CABINET COMMITTEES

standing / ad hoc; reduce workload and coordinate cross-ministry choices

current number, membership and chairs depend on dated notification

CABINET SECRETARIAT

Cabinet support + records + inter-ministerial coordination + crisis management

PMO

staff support, monitoring and policy coordination; not a constitutional substitute for ministries.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/9: Parliamentary control, confidence and anti-defection

INFORMATION

Question Hour -> Zero Hour -> discussions -> committee evidence

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FINANCIAL CONTROL

Budget -> grants -> appropriation -> CAG -> PAC / DRSC

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POLITICAL SANCTION

no-confidence motion in Lok Sabha -> collective resignation if carried

ANTI-DEFECTION INTERFACE

whip supports government stability but can compress independent legislative judgment

CONSTRUCTIVE NO-CONFIDENCE

reform proposal for stability; not current constitutional law in India.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/9: Coalition, minority, caretaker and prime-ministerial government

MAJORITY GOVERNMENT -> stronger agenda control, risk of executive dominance

COALITION -> bargaining and inclusion, risk of fragmented responsibility

MINORITY -> issue-based support and greater parliamentary negotiation

CARETAKER -> continuity with self-restraint; no separate constitutional article

CABINET GOVERNMENT

collective deliberation

ministerial expertise

PRIME-MINISTERIAL GOVERNMENT

central agenda and appointment influence

PMO / communication / electoral leadership

QUALIFIED VERDICT

PM predominance varies with party control, coalition arithmetic, institutions and public legitimacy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/9: Cases, conventions, reforms and the answer spine

CONSTITUTIONAL CONTROLS

Shamsher Singh (1974) -> responsible advice

S.R. Chaudhuri (2001) -> six-month rule cannot be serially abused

Tenth Schedule + 91st Amendment -> stability and anti-defection constraints

PRELIMS FIREWALL

Council != Cabinet | Article 88 gives participation, not a vote without membership

ministry cap uses Lok Sabha strength | Cabinet Committee composition is current-sensitive

REFORM

publish reasons and outcomes, strengthen committees, limit whip, protect Cabinet deliberation

MAINS SPINE

text -> formation -> responsibility -> coordination institutions -> accountability

-> political variation -> balanced strong-executive / responsible-government verdict.